

Competition Volume 1

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This devotional is structured for six days of personal reading, reflection, and prayer. Each day follows the same rhythm: a timeless quote, a scripture passage, a reflection, a moment of stillness, action steps, and a closing prayer. Begin on any day of the week. The order within each day is intentional — let each element do its work before moving to the next.

Day 1: Acts 9:1-3 - Still breathing threats and murder against the disciples of the Lord

Day 2: Acts 9:4-6 - He fell to the ground and heard a voice saying to him

Day 3: Acts 9:7-9 - He was three days without sight

Day 4: Acts 9:10-12 - Inquire at the house of Judas for a man from Tarsus named Saul

Day 5: Acts 9:13-16 - To bear My name before the Gentiles and kings and the sons of Israel

Day 6: Acts 9:17-19 - " And immediately there fell from his eyes something like scales

Day 7: Acts 9:20-22 - Who had come here for the purpose of bringing them bound before the chief priests

Day 8: Acts 9:23-25 - His disciples took him by night and let him down through an opening in the wall

Day 9: Acts 9:26-31 - The church throughout all Judea and Galilee and Samaria enjoyed peace

Day 10: Acts 9:32-35 - He came down also to the saints who lived at Lydda

Day 11: Acts 9:36-39 - In Joppa there was a disciple named Tabitha (which translated in Greek is called Dorcas)

Day 12: Acts 9:40-43 - Peter stayed many days in Joppa with a tanner named Simon

Timeless Wisdom

An ineffable but all-sufficient sacrifice had to be made before God could righteously forgive His people.

- Arthur W. Pink, The Sovereignty of God

Scripture Reading

Acts 9:1-3 (NASB)

Now Saul, still breathing threats and murder against the disciples of the Lord, went to the high priest, and asked for letters from him to the synagogues at Damascus, so that if he found any belonging to the Way, both men and women, he might bring them bound to Jerusalem. As he was traveling, it happened that he was approaching Damascus, and suddenly a light from heaven flashed around him;

Reflection

Acts 9:1-3 opens with a scene marked by steadfast attention under divine warning. The text sets the reader under warning before it offers the comfort of explanation. It brings a concrete moment into view: Still breathing threats and murder against the disciples of the Lord. The first task of reflection is therefore to stay with what the text actually presents in this scene instead of rushing to a broad religious slogan. Because this is narrative material, the theology arrives through events, actions, and speech rather than detached maxims. When Scripture is allowed to set the terms, devotion becomes clearer, steadier, and more truthful. The surrounding context sharpens that reading. Acts 9:1-3 belongs to a larger movement in which God's wisdom, permission, and worth are being tested under pressure. That is why the pastoral burden here is steadfast attention under divine warning, and the theological lane is divine warning against hostile pride. The reader needs to notice what this scene commends, what it exposes, and where it places the heart under pressure. In the language of the passage, Now Saul, still breathing threats and murder against and still, breathing, threats keep the reflection concrete instead of sentimental, detached, or vague. Divine warning refuses casual optimism and trains the heart to take God's opposition to evil with full seriousness. The theological weight of the passage is carried in concrete action rather than abstraction. What we see in Acts 9:1-3 shows how faith responds when suffering, loss, and accusation make reverence costly. God's wisdom is not presented here as a detached principle. It presses into watchful obedience under divine warning instead of casual dismissal. That is why faithful application cannot drift into generic encouragement or into generic encouragement detached from the scene. It must stay close to what the scene actually reveals. The bridge to practice should therefore remain specific. If the scene is shaped by Still breathing threats and murder against the

Still Before God

- Sit with Acts 9:1-3 for two quiet minutes. Read the scene of steadfast attention under divine warning slowly and let it settle before you move on.
- Where does this passage call for sober obedience that takes God's warning seriously in your life today?
- Stay for one more minute and answer God with one honest sentence of trust, repentance, or gratitude before continuing.

Walk It Out

Because Acts 9:1-3 calls for sober obedience that takes God's warning seriously today:

- Name one place where you are tempted to treat Acts 9:1-3 as distant material instead of living warning.
- Take one concrete step today that shows you are receiving Still breathing threats and murder against the disciples of the Lord with sober obedience.

Prayer

Father, thank You for speaking clearly in Acts 9:1-3. In this passage You bring steadfast attention under divine warning into the open through Still breathing threats and murder against the disciples of the Lord. Lord, keep us from reading these words as distant history only, and press them into our ordinary obedience today. Where we resist the truth highlighted in this reflection, bring repentance and renewed trust. Keep us near Your word, and do not let ordinary pressure turn us away from humble obedience. Holy Spirit, take what we have seen in the exposition and turn it into worship instead of mere information. Teach us to remember that Acts 9:1-3 opens with a scene marked by steadfast attention under divine warning. Guard our speech from haste, our work from pride, and our choices from whatever would pull us away from watchful obedience under divine warning instead of casual dismissal. Help us practice the obedience this day requires with humility as we pursue sober obedience that takes God's warning seriously. Amen.

Timeless Wisdom

Resolved, never to do anything which I should be afraid to do if it were the last hour of my life.

- Jonathan Edwards, Resolutions

Scripture Reading

Acts 9:4-6 (NASB)

and he fell to the ground and heard a voice saying to him, "Saul, Saul, why are you persecuting Me?" And he said, "Who are You, Lord?" And He said, "I am Jesus whom you are persecuting, but get up and enter the city, and it will be told you what you must do."

Reflection

Acts 9:4-6 opens with a scene marked by humbled surrender before the risen Lord. The text interrupts the reader with the direct authority of the risen Lord. It brings a concrete moment into view: He fell to the ground and heard a voice saying to him. The first task of reflection is therefore to stay with what the text actually presents in this scene instead of rushing to a broad religious slogan. Because this is narrative material, the theology arrives through events, actions, and speech rather than detached maxims. When Scripture is allowed to set the terms, devotion becomes clearer, steadier, and more truthful. The surrounding context sharpens that reading. Acts 9:4-6 belongs to a larger movement in which God's wisdom, permission, and worth are being tested under pressure. That is why the pastoral burden here is humbled surrender before the risen Lord, and the theological lane is direct confrontation by the risen Lord. The reader needs to notice what this scene commends, what it exposes, and where it places the heart under pressure. In the language of the passage, And he fell to the ground and heard and fell, ground, heard keep the reflection concrete instead of sentimental, detached, or vague. The risen Christ confronts Saul directly, proving that conversion begins not with self-improvement but with divine interruption and exposed rebellion. The theological weight of the passage is carried in concrete action rather than abstraction. What we see in Acts 9:4-6 shows how faith responds when suffering, loss, and accusation make reverence costly. God's wisdom is not presented here as a detached principle. It presses into humbled surrender instead of resisting exposed truth. That is why faithful application cannot drift into generic encouragement or into generic encouragement detached from the scene. It must stay close to what the scene actually reveals. The bridge to practice should therefore remain specific. If the scene is shaped by He fell to the ground and heard a voice saying to him, then obedience today must answer that same pressure point. Where the text exposes fear, we should stop arguing where the risen Christ has made the truth unmistakable. Where it

Still Before God

- Sit with Acts 9:4-6 for two quiet minutes. Read the scene of humbled surrender before the risen Lord slowly and let it settle before you move on.
- Where does this passage call for surrender that stops arguing when Christ exposes the truth in your life today?
- Stay for one more minute and answer God with one honest sentence of trust, repentance, or gratitude before continuing.

Walk It Out

Because Acts 9:4-6 calls for surrender that stops arguing when Christ exposes the truth today:

- Before your next decision, pause and ask how Acts 9:4-6 should shape your response.
- Offer one concrete act of service that matches the patience or steadiness this passage commends.

Prayer

Father, thank You for speaking clearly in Acts 9:4-6. In this passage You bring humbled surrender before the risen Lord into the open through He fell to the ground and heard a voice saying to him. Lord, keep us from reading these words as distant history only, and press them into our ordinary obedience today. Where we resist the truth highlighted in this reflection, bring repentance and renewed trust. Keep us near Your word, and do not let ordinary pressure turn us away from humble obedience. Holy Spirit, take what we have seen in the exposition and turn it into worship instead of mere information. Teach us to remember that Acts 9:4-6 opens with a scene marked by humbled surrender before the risen Lord. Guard our speech from haste, our work from pride, and our choices from whatever would pull us away from humbled surrender instead of resisting exposed truth. Help us practice the obedience this day requires with humility as we pursue surrender that stops arguing when Christ exposes the truth. Amen.

Timeless Wisdom

Discernment is not knowing the difference between right and wrong. It is knowing the difference between right and almost right.

- Charles H. Spurgeon, Spurgeon's Sermons

Scripture Reading

Acts 9:7-9 (NASB)

The men who traveled with him stood speechless, hearing the voice but seeing no one. Saul got up from the ground, and though his eyes were open, he could see nothing; and leading him by the hand, they brought him into Damascus. And he was three days without sight, and neither ate nor drank.

Reflection

Acts 9:7-9 opens with a scene marked by helpless reorientation after pride is broken. The text slows the day into dependence and disorientation so pride can no longer pretend control. It brings a concrete moment into view: He was three days without sight. The first task of reflection is therefore to stay with what the text actually presents in this scene instead of rushing to a broad religious slogan. Because this is narrative material, the theology arrives through events, actions, and speech rather than detached maxims. When Scripture is allowed to set the terms, devotion becomes clearer, steadier, and more truthful. The surrounding context sharpens that reading. Acts 9:7-9 belongs to a larger movement in which God's wisdom, permission, and worth are being tested under pressure. That is why the pastoral burden here is helpless reorientation after pride is broken, and the theological lane is helpless reorientation under divine interruption. The reader needs to notice what this scene commends, what it exposes, and where it places the heart under pressure. In the language of the passage, The men who traveled with him stood speechless and three, days, without keep the reflection concrete instead of sentimental, detached, or vague. Blindness and dependence force a new posture, teaching that pride often has to be broken before calling can be received. The theological weight of the passage is carried in concrete action rather than abstraction. What we see in Acts 9:7-9 shows how faith responds when suffering, loss, and accusation make reverence costly. God's wisdom is not presented here as a detached principle. It presses into teachability instead of prideful self-direction. That is why faithful application cannot drift into generic encouragement or into generic encouragement detached from the scene. It must stay close to what the scene actually reveals. The bridge to practice should therefore remain specific. If the scene is shaped by He was three days without sight, then obedience today must answer that same pressure point. Where the text exposes fear, we should accept

Still Before God

- Sit with Acts 9:7-9 for two quiet minutes. Read the scene of helpless reorientation after pride is broken slowly and let it settle before you move on.
- Where does this passage call for teachability that accepts dependence after pride is broken in your life today?
- Stay for one more minute and answer God with one honest sentence of trust, repentance, or gratitude before continuing.

Walk It Out

Because Acts 9:7-9 calls for teachability that accepts dependence after pride is broken today:

- Write one sentence naming how Acts 9:7-9 presses on the scene of He was three days without sight.
- Name one place where teachability that accepts dependence after pride is broken should change the way you listen, speak, or act today.

Prayer

Father, thank You for speaking clearly in Acts 9:7-9. In this passage You bring helpless reorientation after pride is broken into the open through He was three days without sight. Lord, keep us from reading these words as distant history only, and press them into our ordinary obedience today. Where we resist the truth highlighted in this reflection, bring repentance and renewed trust. Keep us near Your word, and do not let ordinary pressure turn us away from humble obedience. Holy Spirit, take what we have seen in the exposition and turn it into worship instead of mere information. Teach us to remember that Acts 9:7-9 opens with a scene marked by helpless reorientation after pride is broken. Guard our speech from haste, our work from pride, and our choices from whatever would pull us away from teachability instead of prideful self-direction. Help us practice the obedience this day requires with humility as we pursue teachability that accepts dependence after pride is broken. Amen.

Timeless Wisdom

As God delights in His own beauty, so must we learn to delight in His holiness.

- Richard Sibbes, The Bruised Reed

Scripture Reading

Acts 9:10-12 (NASB)

Now there was a disciple at Damascus named Ananias; and the Lord said to him in a vision, "Ananias." And he said, "Here I am, Lord." And the Lord said to him, "Get up and go to the street called Straight, and inquire at the house of Judas for a man from Tarsus named Saul, for he is praying, and he has seen in a vision a man named Ananias come in and lay his hands on him, so that he might regain his sight."

Reflection

Acts 9:10-12 opens with a scene marked by costly obedience that mediates mercy. The text shows mercy arriving through the obedience of one believer toward another. It brings a concrete moment into view: Inquire at the house of Judas for a man from Tarsus named Saul. The first task of reflection is therefore to stay with what the text actually presents in this scene instead of rushing to a broad religious slogan. Because this is narrative material, the theology arrives through events, actions, and speech rather than detached maxims. When Scripture is allowed to set the terms, devotion becomes clearer, steadier, and more truthful. The surrounding context sharpens that reading. Acts 9:10-12 belongs to a larger movement in which God's wisdom, permission, and worth are being tested under pressure. That is why the pastoral burden here is costly obedience that mediates mercy, and the theological lane is obedient mediation in service of God's surprising mercy. The reader needs to notice what this scene commends, what it exposes, and where it places the heart under pressure. In the language of the passage, Now there was a disciple at Damascus named and inquire, house, judas keep the reflection concrete instead of sentimental, detached, or vague. Ananias shows that God's mercy often reaches the astonished sinner through the risky obedience of another believer. The theological weight of the passage is carried in concrete action rather than abstraction. What we see in Acts 9:10-12 shows how faith responds when suffering, loss, and accusation make reverence costly. God's wisdom is not presented here as a detached principle. It presses into costly obedience instead of suspicion toward God's surprising mercy. That is why faithful application cannot drift into generic encouragement or into generic encouragement detached from the scene. It must stay close to what the scene actually reveals. The bridge to practice should therefore remain specific. If the scene is shaped by Inquire at the house of Judas for a man from

Still Before God

- Sit with Acts 9:10-12 for two quiet minutes. Read the scene of costly obedience that mediates mercy slowly and let it settle before you move on.
- Where does this passage call for costly obedience that serves the mercy of God toward surprising people in your life today?
- Stay for one more minute and answer God with one honest sentence of trust, repentance, or gratitude before continuing.

Walk It Out

Because Acts 9:10-12 calls for costly obedience that serves the mercy of God toward surprising people today:

- Before your next decision, pause and ask how Acts 9:10-12 should shape your response.
- Offer one concrete act of service that matches the patience or steadiness this passage commends.

Prayer

Father, thank You for speaking clearly in Acts 9:10-12. In this passage You bring costly obedience that mediates mercy into the open through Inquire at the house of Judas for a man from Tarsus named Saul. Lord, keep us from reading these words as distant history only, and press them into our ordinary obedience today. Where we resist the truth highlighted in this reflection, bring repentance and renewed trust. Keep us near Your word, and do not let ordinary pressure turn us away from humble obedience. Holy Spirit, take what we have seen in the exposition and turn it into worship instead of mere information. Teach us to remember that Acts 9:10-12 opens with a scene marked by costly obedience that mediates mercy. Guard our speech from haste, our work from pride, and our choices from whatever would pull us away from costly obedience instead of suspicion toward God's surprising mercy. Help us practice the obedience this day requires with humility as we pursue costly obedience that serves the mercy of God toward surprising people. Amen.

Timeless Wisdom

Growth in grace is not the work of a day, nor a month, nor a year, but of a whole life.

- Arthur W. Pink, Profiting from the Word

Scripture Reading

Acts 9:13-16 (NASB)

But Ananias answered, "Lord, I have heard from many about this man, how much harm he did to Your saints at Jerusalem; and here he has authority from the chief priests to bind all who call on Your name." But the Lord said to him, "Go, for he is a chosen instrument of Mine, to bear My name before the Gentiles and kings and the sons of Israel; for I will show him how much he must suffer for My name's sake."

Reflection

Acts 9:13-16 opens with a scene marked by costly obedience that mediates mercy. The text shows mercy arriving through the obedience of one believer toward another. It brings a concrete moment into view: To bear My name before the Gentiles and kings and the sons of Israel. The first task of reflection is therefore to stay with what the text actually presents in this scene instead of rushing to a broad religious slogan. Because this is narrative material, the theology arrives through events, actions, and speech rather than detached maxims. When Scripture is allowed to set the terms, devotion becomes clearer, steadier, and more truthful. The surrounding context sharpens that reading. Acts 9:13-16 belongs to a larger movement in which God's wisdom, permission, and worth are being tested under pressure. That is why the pastoral burden here is costly obedience that mediates mercy, and the theological lane is obedient mediation in service of God's surprising mercy. The reader needs to notice what this scene commends, what it exposes, and where it places the heart under pressure. In the language of the passage, But Ananias answered, "Lord, I have heard from and bear, name, gentiles keep the reflection concrete instead of sentimental, detached, or vague. Ananias shows that God's mercy often reaches the astonished sinner through the risky obedience of another believer. The theological weight of the passage is carried in concrete action rather than abstraction. What we see in Acts 9:13-16 shows how faith responds when suffering, loss, and accusation make reverence costly. God's wisdom is not presented here as a detached principle. It presses into costly obedience instead of suspicion toward God's surprising mercy. That is why faithful application cannot drift into generic encouragement or into generic encouragement detached from the scene. It must stay close to what the scene actually reveals. The bridge to practice should therefore remain specific. If the scene is shaped by To bear My name

Still Before God

- Sit with Acts 9:13-16 for two quiet minutes. Read the scene of costly obedience that mediates mercy slowly and let it settle before you move on.
- Where does this passage call for costly obedience that serves the mercy of God toward surprising people in your life today?
- Stay for one more minute and answer God with one honest sentence of trust, repentance, or gratitude before continuing.

Walk It Out

Because Acts 9:13-16 calls for costly obedience that serves the mercy of God toward surprising people today:

→ Name one place where you have been trying to control the outcome, and entrust that concern to God in prayer.

→ End the day by recording one evidence of God's goodness you noticed in work, rest, or relationships.

Prayer

Father, thank You for speaking clearly in Acts 9:13-16. In this passage You bring costly obedience that mediates mercy into the open through To bear My name before the Gentiles and kings and the sons of Israel. Lord, keep us from reading these words as distant history only, and press them into our ordinary obedience today. Where we resist the truth highlighted in this reflection, bring repentance and renewed trust. Keep us near Your word, and do not let ordinary pressure turn us away from humble obedience. Holy Spirit, take what we have seen in the exposition and turn it into worship instead of mere information. Teach us to remember that Acts 9:13-16 opens with a scene marked by costly obedience that mediates mercy. Guard our speech from haste, our work from pride, and our choices from whatever would pull us away from costly obedience instead of suspicion toward God's surprising mercy. Help us practice the obedience this day requires with humility as we pursue costly obedience that serves the mercy of God toward surprising people. Amen.

Timeless Wisdom

I have a great need for Christ: I have a great Christ for my need.

- Charles H. Spurgeon, Metropolitan Tabernacle Pulpit

Scripture Reading

Acts 9:17-19 (NASB)

So Ananias departed and entered the house, and after laying his hands on him said, "Brother Saul, the Lord Jesus, who appeared to you on the road by which you were coming, has sent me so that you may regain your sight and be filled with the Holy Spirit." And immediately there fell from his eyes something like scales, and he regained his sight, and he got up and was baptized; and he took food and was strengthened.

Now for several days he was with the disciples who were at Damascus,

Reflection

Acts 9:17-19 opens with a scene marked by costly obedience that mediates mercy. The text shows mercy arriving through the obedience of one believer toward another. It brings a concrete moment into view: "And immediately there fell from his eyes something like scales. The first task of reflection is therefore to stay with what the text actually presents in this scene instead of rushing to a broad religious slogan. Because this is narrative material, the theology arrives through events, actions, and speech rather than detached maxims. When Scripture is allowed to set the terms, devotion becomes clearer, steadier, and more truthful. The surrounding context sharpens that reading. Acts 9:17-19 belongs to a larger movement in which God's wisdom, permission, and worth are being tested under pressure. That is why the pastoral burden here is costly obedience that mediates mercy, and the theological lane is obedient mediation in service of God's surprising mercy. The reader needs to notice what this scene commends, what it exposes, and where it places the heart under pressure. In the language of the passage, So Ananias departed and entered the house and immediately, fell, his keep the reflection concrete instead of sentimental, detached, or vague. Ananias shows that God's mercy often reaches the astonished sinner through the risky obedience of another believer. The theological weight of the passage is carried in concrete action rather than abstraction. What we see in Acts 9:17-19 shows how faith responds when suffering, loss, and accusation make reverence costly. God's wisdom is not presented here as a detached principle. It presses into costly obedience instead of suspicion toward God's surprising mercy. That is why faithful application cannot drift into generic encouragement or into generic encouragement detached from the scene. It must stay close to what the scene actually reveals. The bridge to practice should therefore remain specific. If the scene is shaped by "And immediately there fell from his eyes

Still Before God

- Sit with Acts 9:17-19 for two quiet minutes. Read the scene of costly obedience that mediates mercy slowly and let it settle before you move on.
- Where does this passage call for costly obedience that serves the mercy of God toward surprising people in your life today?
- Stay for one more minute and answer God with one honest sentence of trust, repentance, or gratitude before continuing.

Walk It Out

Because Acts 9:17-19 calls for costly obedience that serves the mercy of God toward surprising people today:

- Speak one truthful and encouraging sentence to someone today as a direct response to Acts 9:17-19.
- Set aside ten minutes to practice the obedience this reflection emphasized instead of postponing it.

Prayer

Father, thank You for speaking clearly in Acts 9:17-19. In this passage You bring costly obedience that mediates mercy into the open through "And immediately there fell from his eyes something like scales. Lord, keep us from reading these words as distant history only, and press them into our ordinary obedience today. Where we resist the truth highlighted in this reflection, bring repentance and renewed trust. Keep us near Your word, and do not let ordinary pressure turn us away from humble obedience. Holy Spirit, take what we have seen in the exposition and turn it into worship instead of mere information. Teach us to remember that Acts 9:17-19 opens with a scene marked by costly obedience that mediates mercy. Guard our speech from haste, our work from pride, and our choices from whatever would pull us away from costly obedience instead of suspicion toward God's surprising mercy. Help us practice the obedience this day requires with humility as we pursue costly obedience that serves the mercy of God toward surprising people. Amen.

Timeless Wisdom

Prayer is not overcoming God's reluctance, but laying hold of His willingness.

- Martin Luther, Luther's Works (Prayer Selections)

Scripture Reading

Acts 9:20-22 (NASB)

and immediately he began to proclaim Jesus in the synagogues, saying, "He is the Son of God." All those hearing him continued to be amazed, and were saying, "Is this not he who in Jerusalem destroyed those who called on this name, and who had come here for the purpose of bringing them bound before the chief priests?" But Saul kept increasing in strength and confounding the Jews who lived at Damascus by proving that this Jesus is the Christ.

Reflection

Acts 9:20-22 opens with a scene marked by visible transformation under public witness. The text puts changed allegiance into public view instead of leaving conversion hidden. It brings a concrete moment into view: Who had come here for the purpose of bringing them bound before the chief priests. The first task of reflection is therefore to stay with what the text actually presents in this scene instead of rushing to a broad religious slogan. Because this is narrative material, the theology arrives through events, actions, and speech rather than detached maxims. When Scripture is allowed to set the terms, devotion becomes clearer, steadier, and more truthful. The surrounding context sharpens that reading. Acts 9:20-22 belongs to a larger movement in which God's wisdom, permission, and worth are being tested under pressure. That is why the pastoral burden here is visible transformation under public witness, and the theological lane is public transformation that cannot stay hidden. The reader needs to notice what this scene commends, what it exposes, and where it places the heart under pressure. In the language of the passage, And immediately he began to proclaim Jesus in and who, come, here keep the reflection concrete instead of sentimental, detached, or vague. Real conversion becomes publicly visible because new allegiance does not stay hidden when Christ has truly remade the heart. The theological weight of the passage is carried in concrete action rather than abstraction. What we see in Acts 9:20-22 shows how faith responds when suffering, loss, and accusation make reverence costly. God's wisdom is not presented here as a detached principle. It presses into visible faithfulness instead of private religious claim alone. That is why faithful application cannot drift into generic encouragement or into generic encouragement detached from the scene. It must stay close to what the scene actually

Still Before God

- Sit with Acts 9:20-22 for two quiet minutes. Read the scene of visible transformation under public witness slowly and let it settle before you move on.
- Where does this passage call for public faithfulness that lets changed allegiance become visible in your life today?
- Stay for one more minute and answer God with one honest sentence of trust, repentance, or gratitude before continuing.

Walk It Out

Because Acts 9:20-22 calls for public faithfulness that lets changed allegiance become visible today:

- Speak one truthful and encouraging sentence to someone today as a direct response to Acts 9:20-22.
- Set aside ten minutes to practice the obedience this reflection emphasized instead of postponing it.

Prayer

Father, thank You for speaking clearly in Acts 9:20-22. In this passage You bring visible transformation under public witness into the open through Who had come here for the purpose of bringing them bound before the chief priests. Lord, keep us from reading these words as distant history only, and press them into our ordinary obedience today. Where we resist the truth highlighted in this reflection, bring repentance and renewed trust. Keep us near Your word, and do not let ordinary pressure turn us away from humble obedience. Holy Spirit, take what we have seen in the exposition and turn it into worship instead of mere information. Teach us to remember that Acts 9:20-22 opens with a scene marked by visible transformation under public witness. Guard our speech from haste, our work from pride, and our choices from whatever would pull us away from visible faithfulness instead of private religious claim alone. Help us practice the obedience this day requires with humility as we pursue public faithfulness that lets changed allegiance become visible. Amen.

Timeless Wisdom

Without knowledge of self there is no knowledge of God.

- John Calvin, Institutes of the Christian Religion

Scripture Reading

Acts 9:23-25 (NASB)

When many days had elapsed, the Jews plotted together to do away with him, but their plot became known to Saul. They were also watching the gates day and night so that they might put him to death; but his disciples took him by night and let him down through an opening in the wall, lowering him in a large basket.

Reflection

Acts 9:23-25 opens with a scene marked by prepared obedience. The text brings costly obedience into view and refuses every attempt to make sacrifice feel decorative. It brings a concrete moment into view: His disciples took him by night and let him down through an opening in the wall. The first task of reflection is therefore to stay with what the text actually presents in this scene instead of rushing to a broad religious slogan. Because this is narrative material, the theology arrives through events, actions, and speech rather than detached maxims. When Scripture is allowed to set the terms, devotion becomes clearer, steadier, and more truthful. The surrounding context sharpens that reading. Acts 9:23-25 belongs to a larger movement in which God's wisdom, permission, and worth are being tested under pressure. That is why the pastoral burden here is prepared obedience, and the theological lane is watchful surrender before costly obedience. The reader needs to notice what this scene commends, what it exposes, and where it places the heart under pressure. In the language of the passage, When many days had elapsed, the Jews plotted and his, disciples, took keep the reflection concrete instead of sentimental, detached, or vague. The crucifixion scene forces attention on shame, suffering, and the holy cost of redemption rather than sentimental encouragement. The theological weight of the passage is carried in concrete action rather than abstraction. What we see in Acts 9:23-25 shows how faith responds when suffering, loss, and accusation make reverence costly. God's wisdom is not presented here as a detached principle. It presses into obedient love instead of self-saving instinct. That is why faithful application cannot drift into generic encouragement or into generic encouragement detached from the scene. It must stay close to what the scene actually reveals. The bridge to practice should therefore remain specific. If the scene is shaped by His disciples took him by night and let him down through an opening in the wall, then obedience today must answer that same pressure point. Where the text exposes fear, we should carry costly obedience without bitterness. Where it honors devotion, we

Still Before God

- Sit with Acts 9:23-25 for two quiet minutes. Read the scene of prepared obedience slowly and let it settle before you move on.
- Where does this passage call for grateful obedience within God's generous boundaries in your life today?
- Stay for one more minute and answer God with one honest sentence of confession, courage, or repentance before continuing.

Walk It Out

Because Acts 9:23-25 calls for grateful obedience within God's generous boundaries today:

- Name one costly act of obedience that Acts 9:23-25 places before you today.
- Accept one inconvenience without complaint as a small act of cross-shaped faithfulness.

Prayer

Father, thank You for speaking clearly in Acts 9:23-25. In this passage You bring prepared obedience into the open through His disciples took him by night and let him down through an opening in the wall. Lord, keep us from reading these words as distant history only, and press them into our ordinary obedience today. Where we resist the truth highlighted in this reflection, bring repentance and renewed trust. Keep us near the crucified Christ, and do not let us soften suffering love into something easier than holy obedience. Holy Spirit, take what we have seen in the exposition and turn it into worship instead of mere information. Teach us to remember that Acts 9:23-25 opens with a scene marked by prepared obedience. Guard our speech from haste, our work from pride, and our choices from whatever would pull us away from obedient love instead of self-saving instinct. Help us practice the obedience this day requires with humility as we pursue grateful obedience within God's generous boundaries. Amen.

Timeless Wisdom

Be killing sin, or sin will be killing you.

- John Owen, Of the Mortification of Sin

Scripture Reading

Acts 9:26-31 (NASB)

When he came to Jerusalem, he was trying to associate with the disciples; but they were all afraid of him, not believing that he was a disciple. But Barnabas took hold of him and brought him to the apostles and described to them how he had seen the Lord on the road, and that He had talked to him, and how at Damascus he had spoken out boldly in the name of Jesus. And he was with them, moving about freely in Jerusalem, speaking out boldly in the name of the Lord. And he was talking and arguing with the Hellenistic Jews; but they were attempting to put him to death. But when the brethren learned of it, they brought him down to Caesarea and sent him away to Tarsus.

So the church throughout all Judea and Galilee and Samaria enjoyed peace, being built up; and going on in the fear of the Lord and in the comfort of the Holy Spirit, it continued to increase.

Reflection

Acts 9:26-31 opens with a scene marked by strengthening peace under holy comfort. The text frames peace as strengthening life under God's holy comfort. It brings a concrete moment into view: The church throughout all Judea and Galilee and Samaria enjoyed peace. The first task of reflection is therefore to stay with what the text actually presents in this scene instead of rushing to a broad religious slogan. Because this is narrative material, the theology arrives through events, actions, and speech rather than detached maxims. When Scripture is allowed to set the terms, devotion becomes clearer, steadier, and more truthful. The surrounding context sharpens that reading. Acts 9:26-31 belongs to a larger movement in which God's wisdom, permission, and worth are being tested under pressure. That is why the pastoral burden here is strengthening peace under holy comfort, and the theological lane is strengthening peace under the fear and comfort of God. The reader needs to notice what this scene commends, what it exposes, and where it places the heart under pressure. In the language of the passage, When he came to Jerusalem, he was trying and church, throughout, all keep the reflection concrete instead of sentimental, detached, or vague. Church peace here is not complacency but strengthening rest under the fear of the Lord and the comfort of the Holy Spirit. The theological weight of the passage is carried in concrete action rather than abstraction. What we see in Acts 9:26-31

Still Before God

- Sit with Acts 9:26-31 for two quiet minutes. Read the scene of strengthening peace under holy comfort slowly and let it settle before you move on.
- Where does this passage call for quiet faithfulness that builds up the church under holy comfort in your life today?
- Stay for one more minute and answer God with one honest sentence of trust, repentance, or gratitude before continuing.

Walk It Out

Because Acts 9:26-31 calls for quiet faithfulness that builds up the church under holy comfort today:

- Write one sentence naming how Acts 9:26-31 presses on the scene of The church throughout all Judea and Galilee and Samaria enjoyed peace.
- Name one place where quiet faithfulness that builds up the church under holy comfort should change the way you listen, speak, or act today.

Prayer

Father, thank You for speaking clearly in Acts 9:26-31. In this passage You bring strengthening peace under holy comfort into the open through The church throughout all Judea and Galilee and Samaria enjoyed peace. Lord, keep us from reading these words as distant history only, and press them into our ordinary obedience today. Where we resist the truth highlighted in this reflection, bring repentance and renewed trust. Keep us near Your word, and do not let ordinary pressure turn us away from humble obedience. Holy Spirit, take what we have seen in the exposition and turn it into worship instead of mere information. Teach us to remember that Acts 9:26-31 opens with a scene marked by strengthening peace under holy comfort. Guard our speech from haste, our work from pride, and our choices from whatever would pull us away from strengthening peace instead of restless self-importance. Help us practice the obedience this day requires with humility as we pursue quiet faithfulness that builds up the church under holy comfort. Amen.

Timeless Wisdom

Faith's greatest triumphs are achieved in the hour of deepest darkness.

- Samuel Rutherford, Letters of Samuel Rutherford

Scripture Reading

Acts 9:32-35 (NASB)

Now as Peter was traveling through all those regions, he came down also to the saints who lived at Lydda. There he found a man named Aeneas, who had been bedridden eight years, for he was paralyzed. Peter said to him, "Aeneas, Jesus Christ heals you; get up and make your bed." Immediately he got up. And all who lived at Lydda and Sharon saw him, and they turned to the Lord.

Reflection

Acts 9:32-35 opens with a scene marked by faithful response to God's word. The text does not ask the reader to admire the moment from a distance. It brings a concrete moment into view: He came down also to the saints who lived at Lydda. The first task of reflection is therefore to stay with what the text actually presents in this scene instead of rushing to a broad religious slogan. Because this is narrative material, the theology arrives through events, actions, and speech rather than detached maxims. When Scripture is allowed to set the terms, devotion becomes clearer, steadier, and more truthful. The surrounding context sharpens that reading. Acts 9:32-35 belongs to a larger movement in which God's wisdom, permission, and worth are being tested under pressure. That is why the pastoral burden here is faithful response to God's word, and the theological lane is faithful response to God's word. The reader needs to notice what this scene commends, what it exposes, and where it places the heart under pressure. In the language of the passage, Now as Peter was traveling through all those and came, down, also keep the reflection concrete instead of sentimental, detached, or vague. The theological weight of the passage is carried in concrete action rather than abstraction. What we see in Acts 9:32-35 shows how faith responds when suffering, loss, and accusation make reverence costly. God's wisdom is not presented here as a detached principle. It presses into faithful response instead of vague admiration. That is why faithful application cannot drift into generic encouragement or into generic encouragement detached from the scene. It must stay close to what the scene actually reveals. The bridge to practice should therefore remain specific. If the scene is shaped by He came down also to the saints who lived at Lydda, then obedience today must answer that same pressure point. Where the text exposes fear, we should answer the word with concrete obedience. Where it honors devotion, we should practice concrete obedience under the authority of the passage. Where it reveals God's worth clearly, we

Still Before God

- Sit with Acts 9:32-35 for two quiet minutes. Read the scene of faithful response to God's word slowly and let it settle before you move on.
- Where does this passage call for concrete obedience under the authority of the passage in your life today?
- Stay for one more minute and answer God with one honest sentence of trust, repentance, or gratitude before continuing.

Walk It Out

Because Acts 9:32-35 calls for concrete obedience under the authority of the passage today:

- Before your next decision, pause and ask how Acts 9:32-35 should shape your response.
- Offer one concrete act of service that matches the patience or steadiness this passage commends.

Prayer

Father, thank You for speaking clearly in Acts 9:32-35. In this passage You bring faithful response to God's word into the open through He came down also to the saints who lived at Lydda. Lord, keep us from reading these words as distant history only, and press them into our ordinary obedience today. Where we resist the truth highlighted in this reflection, bring repentance and renewed trust. Keep us near Your word, and do not let ordinary pressure turn us away from humble obedience. Holy Spirit, take what we have seen in the exposition and turn it into worship instead of mere information. Teach us to remember that Acts 9:32-35 opens with a scene marked by faithful response to God's word. Guard our speech from haste, our work from pride, and our choices from whatever would pull us away from faithful response instead of vague admiration. Help us practice the obedience this day requires with humility as we pursue concrete obedience under the authority of the passage. Amen.

Timeless Wisdom

*A dog barks when his master is attacked. I would be a coward if I saw
God's truth attacked and yet would remain silent.*

- John Calvin, Sermons and Letters

Scripture Reading

Acts 9:36-39 (NASB)

Now in Joppa there was a disciple named Tabitha (which translated in Greek is called Dorcas); this woman was abounding with deeds of kindness and charity which she continually did. And it happened at that time that she fell sick and died; and when they had washed her body, they laid it in an upper room. Since Lydda was near Joppa, the disciples, having heard that Peter was there, sent two men to him, imploring him, "Do not delay in coming to us." So Peter arose and went with them. When he arrived, they brought him into the upper room; and all the widows stood beside him, weeping and showing all the tunics and garments that Dorcas used to make while she was with them.

Reflection

Acts 9:36-39 opens with a scene marked by resurrection mercy in community life. The text turns mercy into visible resurrection-shaped hope before a watching community. It brings a concrete moment into view: In Joppa there was a disciple named Tabitha (which translated in Greek is called Dorcas). The first task of reflection is therefore to stay with what the text actually presents in this scene instead of rushing to a broad religious slogan. Because this is narrative material, the theology arrives through events, actions, and speech rather than detached maxims. When Scripture is allowed to set the terms, devotion becomes clearer, steadier, and more truthful. The surrounding context sharpens that reading. Acts 9:36-39 belongs to a larger movement in which God's wisdom, permission, and worth are being tested under pressure. That is why the pastoral burden here is resurrection mercy in community life, and the theological lane is resurrection mercy that strengthens communal witness. The reader needs to notice what this scene commends, what it exposes, and where it places the heart under pressure. In the language of the passage, Now in Joppa there was a disciple named and joppa, disciple, named keep the reflection concrete instead of sentimental, detached, or vague. Resurrection mercy strengthens communal witness by turning compassion into visible hope before many observers. The theological weight of the passage is carried in concrete action rather than abstraction. What we see in Acts 9:36-39 shows how faith responds when suffering, loss, and accusation make reverence costly. God's wisdom is not presented here as a detached

Still Before God

- Sit with Acts 9:36-39 for two quiet minutes. Read the scene of resurrection mercy in community life slowly and let it settle before you move on.
- Where does this passage call for acts of mercy that strengthen resurrection-shaped witness in community in your life today?
- Stay for one more minute and answer God with one honest sentence of trust, repentance, or gratitude before continuing.

Walk It Out

Because Acts 9:36-39 calls for acts of mercy that strengthen resurrection-shaped witness in community today:

- Write one sentence naming how Acts 9:36-39 presses on the scene of In Joppa there was a disciple named Tabitha (which translated in Greek is called Dorcas).
- Name one place where acts of mercy that strengthen resurrection-shaped witness in community should change the way you listen, speak, or act today.

Prayer

Father, thank You for speaking clearly in Acts 9:36-39. In this passage You bring resurrection mercy in community life into the open through In Joppa there was a disciple named Tabitha (which translated in Greek is called Dorcas). Lord, keep us from reading these words as distant history only, and press them into our ordinary obedience today. Where we resist the truth highlighted in this reflection, bring repentance and renewed trust. Keep us near Your word, and do not let ordinary pressure turn us away from humble obedience. Holy Spirit, take what we have seen in the exposition and turn it into worship instead of mere information. Teach us to remember that Acts 9:36-39 opens with a scene marked by resurrection mercy in community life. Guard our speech from haste, our work from pride, and our choices from whatever would pull us away from resurrection mercy instead of detached admiration of power. Help us practice the obedience this day requires with humility as we pursue acts of mercy that strengthen resurrection-shaped witness in community. Amen.

Timeless Wisdom

Though we cannot think alike, may we not love alike?

- John Wesley, Sermons and Tracts

Scripture Reading

Acts 9:40-43 (NASB)

But Peter sent them all out and knelt down and prayed, and turning to the body, he said, "Tabitha, arise." And she opened her eyes, and when she saw Peter, she sat up. And he gave her his hand and raised her up; and calling the saints and widows, he presented her alive. It became known all over Joppa, and many believed in the Lord. And Peter stayed many days in Joppa with a tanner named Simon.

Reflection

Acts 9:40-43 opens with a scene marked by resurrection mercy in community life. The text turns mercy into visible resurrection-shaped hope before a watching community. It brings a concrete moment into view: Peter stayed many days in Joppa with a tanner named Simon. The first task of reflection is therefore to stay with what the text actually presents in this scene instead of rushing to a broad religious slogan. Because this is narrative material, the theology arrives through events, actions, and speech rather than detached maxims. When Scripture is allowed to set the terms, devotion becomes clearer, steadier, and more truthful. The surrounding context sharpens that reading. Acts 9:40-43 belongs to a larger movement in which God's wisdom, permission, and worth are being tested under pressure. That is why the pastoral burden here is resurrection mercy in community life, and the theological lane is resurrection mercy that strengthens communal witness. The reader needs to notice what this scene commends, what it exposes, and where it places the heart under pressure. In the language of the passage, But Peter sent them all out and knelt and peter, stayed, many keep the reflection concrete instead of sentimental, detached, or vague. Resurrection mercy strengthens communal witness by turning compassion into visible hope before many observers. The theological weight of the passage is carried in concrete action rather than abstraction. What we see in Acts 9:40-43 shows how faith responds when suffering, loss, and accusation make reverence costly. God's wisdom is not presented here as a detached principle. It presses into resurrection mercy instead of detached admiration of power. That is why faithful application cannot drift into generic encouragement or into generic encouragement detached from the scene. It must stay close to what the scene actually reveals. The bridge to practice should therefore remain specific. If the scene is shaped by Peter, Peter stayed many days in Joppa with a tanner named Simon, then obedience today must answer that same pressure point. Where the

Still Before God

- Sit with Acts 9:40-43 for two quiet minutes. Read the scene of resurrection mercy in community life slowly and let it settle before you move on.
- Where does this passage call for acts of mercy that strengthen resurrection-shaped witness in community in your life today?
- Stay for one more minute and answer God with one honest sentence of trust, repentance, or gratitude before continuing.

Walk It Out

Because Acts 9:40-43 calls for acts of mercy that strengthen resurrection-shaped witness in community today:

- Before your next decision, pause and ask how Acts 9:40-43 should shape your response.
- Offer one concrete act of service that matches the patience or steadiness this passage commends.

Prayer

Father, thank You for speaking clearly in Acts 9:40-43. In this passage You bring resurrection mercy in community life into the open through Peter stayed many days in Joppa with a tanner named Simon. Lord, keep us from reading these words as distant history only, and press them into our ordinary obedience today. Where we resist the truth highlighted in this reflection, bring repentance and renewed trust. Keep us near Your word, and do not let ordinary pressure turn us away from humble obedience. Holy Spirit, take what we have seen in the exposition and turn it into worship instead of mere information. Teach us to remember that Acts 9:40-43 opens with a scene marked by resurrection mercy in community life. Guard our speech from haste, our work from pride, and our choices from whatever would pull us away from resurrection mercy instead of detached admiration of power. Help us practice the obedience this day requires with humility as we pursue acts of mercy that strengthen resurrection-shaped witness in community. Amen.

Footnotes

1. Arthur W. Pink, *The Sovereignty of God*, (1918).
2. Jonathan Edwards, *Resolutions*, (1722).
3. Charles H. Spurgeon, *Spurgeon's Sermons*, (1879).
4. Richard Sibbes, *The Bruised Reed*, (1630).
5. Arthur W. Pink, *Profiting from the Word*, (1932).
6. Charles H. Spurgeon, *Metropolitan Tabernacle Pulpit*, (1888).
7. Martin Luther, *Luther's Works (Prayer Selections)*, (1535).
8. John Calvin, *Institutes of the Christian Religion*, (1536).
9. John Owen, *Of the Mortification of Sin*, (1656).
10. Samuel Rutherford, *Letters of Samuel Rutherford*, (1664).
11. John Calvin, *Sermons and Letters*, (1561).
12. John Wesley, *Sermons and Tracts*, (1770).

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